

- o Task 1 – one role play recommended to last between two to two and a half minutes for 10 marks
- o Task 2 – one picture-based task recommended to last between three to three-and-a-half minutes for 24 marks
- o Task 3 – a conversation recommended to last between five to six minutes for 36 marks.

Students are allocated 12 minutes' preparation time, under supervised conditions, immediately prior to the assessment for tasks 1 and 2. The purpose is to consider the questions and stimulus for the role play and picture-based scenarios allocated.

Students are permitted to make notes (up to a maximum of one side of A4 for both tasks 1 and 2) during this period and they can refer to them during the role play and picture-based assessment, but not during the conversation task. Students must return their notes to the teacher before commencing task 3 (conversation).

The notes should be for reference only and students must not read out whole, prepared sentences in answer to questions.

Any notes made during the preparation time must be kept securely by the centre until the end of October in the year the assessment is completed, after which time they should be securely destroyed.

Students cannot have access to a dictionary, or any other resource, during the preparation time.

Task 1 - Role play

Pearson will set and provide ten different sets of role plays for each tier. Each role play consists of two cards – one for the teacher and one for the student.

Teacher card

The teacher cards contain instructions on how to conduct the role play and the exact questions to ask.

Each role play opens with an introduction from the teacher, who then asks the first question.

Candidate card

The candidate cards include prompts as a guide and highlights where the candidate needs to ask a question (indicated by the symbol '?') and where an unpredictable question is posed to them by the teacher (indicated by the symbol '!').

Students have access to this during their preparation time to help in preparing for the assessment.

The candidate cards each contain instructions in English and the task in Spanish. The context of the role play is provided in both sections. Candidates must read both sections fully to support understanding each bullet point.

At the Foundation tier, the candidate cards contain five bullet points, eliciting five utterances. Students need to ask one question and respond to one unpredictable question. Students are required to speak only in the present tense or they may use a familiar conditional tense where it is more natural to do so, e.g. 'me gustaría.'

At the Higher tier, the candidate cards contain five bullet points, eliciting five utterances. Students need to ask two questions and respond to one unpredictable questions. Students are required to speak in the present tense (or they may also use a conditional tense if it is more natural to do so) and respond to one question set in a past tense.

Pearson will provide ten different sets of picture-based tasks for each tier. Each task consists of two cards – one for the teacher and one for the student.

Teacher card

The teacher cards contain instructions on how to conduct this task and the five questions to ask the student. Teachers are allowed to repeat questions and use set prompts to enable students to give a developed response. They are not allowed to deviate from the set prompts.

Each task opens with the teacher asking the first question which is based on the picture.

The first question is directly based on the picture; the remaining questions extend beyond the picture, but are based on the overall topic from which the picture is drawn, inviting an exchange of views or opinions.

Candidate card

At the Foundation tier, students are provided with a picture and five bullets in Spanish to help in preparing for the five questions that will be asked during the assessment. Students are allowed to ask for questions to be repeated.

Students have access to this during their preparation time.

At the Higher tier, students are provided with a picture and five bullets in Spanish to help in preparing for the five questions that will be asked during the assessment. The final bullet is marked by the symbol '!' to denote one unpredictable question. Students are allowed to ask for questions to be repeated.

Students have access to this during their preparation time.

The first part of the conversation opens with the topic chosen by the student. The student may choose to focus on any aspect(s) of the topic as each has a number of different features. For example, a student who has selected the topic *What school is like* may:

- choose to focus on “school types” and “rules and pressures”, or
- choose only to focus on “rules and pressures”.

To enable them to make a confident start, the teacher should allow the student to state their chosen aspect(s) from their nominated topic and to talk about this aspect/these aspects for up to one minute.

The teacher continues the conversation on the chosen topic and then may move on to other topics within the same theme, if necessary, to ensure that students use the recommended time for this task most effectively.

The second part of the conversation is based on a different theme allocated by Pearson and covers any of the topics across that single theme.

Teachers must ensure that **an equal amount of time** is allocated to both parts of the conversation.

Throughout the conversation, in order to facilitate a genuine and spontaneous interaction, the nature of questions from the teacher should enable students to:

- answer questions freely, in turn allowing them to produce extended sequences of speech
- develop conversations and discussions
- give and justify own thoughts and opinions
- refer to past, present and future events.

Preparation time and notes for tasks 1 and 2 only

- The notes made during the preparation time should be a reference only, and students should not read out whole, prepared sentences.
- The preparation time **must** be supervised. It can take place either in the examination room with the teacher or outside of the room with an invigilator.
- Students are not permitted to write on the candidate cards.
- Students must return their notes and candidate cards to the teacher at the end of the second task (picture-based task).
- Any notes made during the preparation time must be kept securely by the centre until the end of October in the year the assessment is completed, after which time they should be securely destroyed.
- Students cannot have access to a dictionary, or any other resource, during the preparation time.

Sample assessment materials

Sample candidate and teacher cards for the role play and picture-based tasks and accompanying marking guidance and assessment criteria can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Spanish* Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.

Marking guidance and assessment criteria are also provided in this document.

This marking guidance is for the use of Pearson-appointed external examiners. The guidance has been included for teacher reference to aid understanding of how the assessment criteria will be applied.

General guidance on using levels-based mark schemes

Step 1 Decide on a band

- The examiner will first of all consider the answer as a whole and then decide which descriptors most closely match the answer and place it in that band. The descriptors for each band indicate the different features that will be seen in the student's answer for that band.
- When assigning a level they will look at the overall quality of the answer and not focus disproportionately on small and specific parts of the answer where the student has not performed quite as well as the rest. If the answer covers different aspects of different bands of the mark scheme they will use a 'best fit' approach for defining the level and then use the variability of the response to help decide the mark within the level, for example if the response is predominantly band 5–8 with a small amount of band 9–12 material, it would be placed in band 5–8 but be awarded a mark near the top of the band because of the band 9–12 content.

Step 2 Decide on a mark

- Once they have decided on a band they will then need to decide on a mark within the band.
- They will decide on the mark to award based on the quality of the answer; they will award a mark towards the top or bottom of that band depending on how the student has evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- They will modify the mark based on how securely the trait descriptors are met at that band.
- They will need to go back through the answer as they apply the mark scheme to clarify points and assure themselves that the band and the mark are appropriate.

Role play – Foundation tier (10 marks)

For this task, students' work is marked by Pearson using the following assessment criteria. The mark grid is applied once to **each individual response to the prompts**. There is a maximum of 2 marks for each of the five prompts on the role play cards.

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable communication; highly ambiguous OR pronunciation prevents communication
1	Partially clear/ambiguous OR partially appropriate within the context of the role play; pronunciation may affect clarity of communication
2	Clearly communicated; appropriate within the context of the role play; unambiguous; pronunciation supports clear communication

Exemplification of how to apply the role-play mark grid can be found in Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9-1) in Spanish Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.

Additional guidance

Appropriate: relevant response related to the prompt, uses appropriate register for the scenario.

Partially clear / Pronunciation may affect clarity of communication: makes speech difficult to understand immediately (even if the meaning is eventually understood)/forces the listener to strain to understand what is meant.

Picture-based task – Foundation tier (24 marks)

There are two mark grids to be applied to this task which are:

- communication and content
- linguistic knowledge and accuracy.

Picture-based task: communication and content - Foundation tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–4	• Limited response to set questions, likely to consist of single-word answers • Minimal success in adapting language to describe, narrate, inform using individual words/phrases; sometimes unable to respond • A straightforward opinion may be expressed but without justification • Pronunciation and intonation are inconsistently intelligible with inaccuracies that lead to frequent impairment in communication
5–8	• Responds briefly to set questions, there is much hesitation and continuous prompting needed • Some limited success in adapting language, to describe, narrate and inform in response to the set questions; may occasionally be unable to respond • Straightforward, brief opinions are given but without justification • Pronunciation and intonation are mostly intelligible but inaccuracies lead to some impairment in communication
9–12	• Responds to set questions with some development, some hesitation and some prompting necessary • Some effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform in response to the set questions • Expresses opinions with occasional, brief justification • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, occasionally inaccuracies affect clarity of communication
13–16	• Responds to set questions with frequently developed responses, occasional hesitation, occasional prompting necessary • Frequently effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform in response to the set questions • Expresses opinions and gives justification with some development • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, inaccuracies are minimal and have no impact on clarity of communication

Additional guidance

Adaptation of/adapting language to describe, narrate and inform: adapts language to achieve different purposes in the language; students may adapt language more effectively for one purpose than another, for example they may use language effectively to inform but less effectively to narrate.

Straightforward opinions and justification are those that form part of a minimum/standard/predictable response.

Picture-based task: linguistic knowledge and accuracy - Foundation tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–2	- Limited accuracy when responding to set questions; minimal success when referring to past, present and future events - Individual words and phrases are coherent when responding to set questions; high frequency of errors prevent meaning throughout most of the conversation
3–4	- Occasionally accurate grammatical structures when responding to set questions; occasional success when referring to present events, limited success when referring to future or past events, much ambiguity - Some coherent phrases and sentences within responses to set questions; regular errors prevent coherent overall speech and frequently prevent meaning
5–6	- Some accurate grammatical structures, including some successful references to past, present and future events in response to the set questions, some ambiguity - Responses are partially coherent, errors occur that sometimes hinder clarity of communication and occasionally prevent meaning being conveyed
7–8	- Generally accurate grammatical structures, generally successful references to past, present and future events in response to the set questions, occasional ambiguity - Responses are generally coherent although errors occur that occasionally hinder clarity of communication

Additional guidance

Errors: The mark grid describes the frequency of errors and the impact that errors have on clarity.

Errors that **do not hinder clarity:**

- errors that do not affect meaning, for example gender, adjectival agreements
- infrequent errors that do not distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **hinder clarity:**

- errors that make speech difficult to understand immediately (even if the meaning is eventually understood)/errors that force listeners to strain to understand what is meant, for example inappropriate tense formation, mismatch of subject and the possessive adjective
- frequent errors hinder clarity as they will distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **prevent meaning being conveyed:**

- errors that mean the listener cannot understand the message
- errors that convey the wrong message
- errors that make it unclear who is doing the action, i.e. using the incorrect person of the verb
- mother-tongue interference.

NB: these are examples only and do not constitute a finite list.

Conversation – Foundation tier (36 marks)

There are three mark grids to be applied to this task which are:

- communication and content
- interaction and spontaneity
- linguistic knowledge and accuracy.

Conversation: communication and content - Foundation tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–3	• Communicates limited information relevant to the topics and questions • Uses language to express limited, straightforward ideas and thoughts; occasional straightforward opinion expressed without justification • Uses limited, familiar vocabulary and expression with much repetition; communication is disjointed and frequently breaks down because of restricted range of vocabulary • Pronunciation and intonation are inconsistently intelligible with inaccuracies that lead to frequent impairment in communication
4–6	• Communicates brief information relevant to the topics and questions • Uses language to produce straightforward ideas and thoughts; expresses straightforward opinions with limited justification • Uses repetitive, familiar vocabulary and expression; communication is often constrained and occasionally breaks down because of restricted range of vocabulary • Pronunciation and intonation are mostly intelligible but inaccuracies lead to some impairment in communication
7–9	• Communicates information relevant to the topics and questions, with occasionally extended sequences of speech • Uses language to produce straightforward ideas, thoughts and opinions with occasional justification • Uses a limited variety of mainly straightforward vocabulary, communication for some purposes is constrained because of restricted range of vocabulary • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, occasionally inaccuracies affect clarity of communication
10–12	• Communicates information relevant to the topics and questions, with some extended sequences of speech • Occasionally uses language creatively to express some individual thoughts, ideas and opinions, some of which are justified • Occasional variety in use of vocabulary, including some examples of uncommon language with some variation of expression, fulfils most purposes • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, inaccuracies are minimal and have no impact on clarity of communication

Additional guidance

Uses language creatively – examples of creative language use are:

- using language to create an effect
- manipulating language, including familiar, high-frequency and simple language, to respond to unfamiliar/unexpected contexts and purposes
- using language to express thoughts, ideas, feelings and emotions
- using language to inform and narrate ideas, thoughts and points of view to maintain interest
- applying a variety of vocabulary and structures to maintain interest
- using language effectively to achieve more complex purposes, for example to interest, to convince.

Individual thoughts, ideas and opinions: this is linked to creative use of language whereby students use language to express original thoughts, ideas and points of view which go beyond the minimum/standard/predictable response.

Straightforward ideas, thoughts and opinions are those that give the minimum/standard/predictable response.

Conversation: interaction and spontaneity - Foundation tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–3	• Basic exchange where only some questions are responded to; answers rely on rehearsed language that is frequently irrelevant to the question • Short, undeveloped responses, many incomplete • Isolated examples of ability to sustain communication, pace is slow and hesitant throughout
4–6	• Responds with limited spontaneity; answers rely on rehearsed language that is occasionally irrelevant to the question • Short responses, any development depends on teacher prompting • Limited ability to sustain communication, pace is mostly slow and hesitant
7–9	• Occasionally able to respond spontaneously with some examples of natural interaction although often stilted • Occasionally able to initiate and develop responses independently but regular prompting needed • Occasionally able to sustain communication, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow; frequent hesitation
10–12	• Responds spontaneously to some questions, interacting naturally for parts of the conversation • Sometimes able to initiate and develop the conversation independently, some prompting needed • Sometimes able to sustain communication, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow; some hesitation

Additional guidance

Rephrasing/repair strategies: strategies that aid communication and allow the conversation to be sustained, for example rephrasing, circumlocution, adjusting the message, asking for clarification/repetition, repair strategies such as self-correction; these strategies enable students to deliver the message when exact vocabulary or expressions are not known.

Responds/responding spontaneously: gives a relevant, impromptu response based on what they have heard.

Rehearsed language: language learned by heart, which may not give a relevant, impromptu response based on what has been heard (not spontaneous).

Conversation: linguistic knowledge and accuracy - Foundation tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–3	• Uses straightforward, individual words/phrases; limited evidence of language manipulation • Limited accuracy, minimal success when referring to past, present and future events • Individual words and phrases are coherent; high frequency of errors prevent meaning throughout much of the conversation
4–6	• Uses straightforward, repetitive, grammatical structures • Occasionally accurate grammatical structures, occasional success when referring to present events, limited success when referring to future or past events, much ambiguity • Some coherent phrases and sentences; regular errors prevent coherent overall speech and frequently prevent meaning
7–9	• Manipulates a limited variety of mainly straightforward grammatical structures, minimal use of complex structures • Some accurate grammatical structures, some successful references to past, present and future events, some ambiguity • Sequences of coherent speech although errors occur that often hinder clarity of communication and occasionally prevent meaning being conveyed
10–12	• Manipulates grammatical structures with occasional variation, complex structures used but repetitive • Generally accurate grammatical structures, generally successful references to past, present and future events • Generally coherent speech although errors occur that sometimes hinder clarity of communication

Additional guidance

Complex grammatical structures are considered to be:

- varied and complex word order
- using extended sentences that include a range of structures, for example conjunctions, pronouns, reported speech and/or a range of lexis, for example to express abstract ideas/convey justified arguments
- conceptually more challenging language.

Straightforward grammatical structures are considered to be:

- repetitive, simple word order
- short, simple sentences that use a repetitive range of common, high-frequency structures
- simple ideas, opinions and thoughts that are expressed but are not justified.

Errors: The mark grid describes the frequency of errors and the impact that errors have on clarity.

Errors that **do not hinder clarity:**

- errors that do not affect meaning, for example gender, adjectival agreements
- infrequent errors that do not distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **hinder clarity**:

- errors that make speech difficult to understand immediately (even if the meaning is eventually understood)/errors that force listeners to strain to understand what is meant, for example inappropriate tense formation, mismatch of subject and the possessive adjective
- frequent errors hinder clarity as they will distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **prevent meaning being conveyed**:

- errors that mean the listener cannot understand the message
- errors that convey the wrong message
- errors that make it unclear who is doing the action, i.e. using the incorrect person of the verb
- mother-tongue interference.

NB: these are examples only and do not constitute a finite list.

Role play – Higher tier (10 marks)

For this task, students' work is marked by Pearson using the following assessment criteria. The mark grid is applied once to **each individual response to the prompts**. There is a maximum of 2 marks for each of the five prompts on the role play cards.

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable communication; highly ambiguous OR pronunciation prevents communication
1	Partially clear/ambiguous OR partially appropriate within the context of the role play; pronunciation may affect clarity of communication
2	Clearly communicated; appropriate within the context of the role play; unambiguous; pronunciation supports clear communication

Exemplification of how to apply the role-play mark grid can be found in Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9-1) in Spanish Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.

Additional guidance

Appropriate: relevant response related to the prompt, uses appropriate register for the scenario.

Partially clear / Pronunciation may affect clarity of communication: makes speech difficult to understand immediately (even if the meaning is eventually understood)/forces the listener to strain to understand what is meant.

Picture-based task – Higher tier (24 marks)

There are two mark grids to be applied to this task which are:

- communication and content
- linguistic knowledge and accuracy.

Picture-based task: communication and content - Higher tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–4	• Responds to set questions with some development, some hesitation and some prompting necessary • Some effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform in response to the set questions • Expresses opinions with occasional, brief justification • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, occasionally inaccuracies affect clarity of communication
5–8	• Responds to set questions with frequently developed responses, occasional hesitation, occasional prompting necessary • Frequently effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform in response to the set questions • Expresses opinions and gives justification with some development • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, inaccuracies are minimal and have no impact on clarity of communication
9–12	• Responds to set questions with mostly developed and fluent responses, minimal hesitation and minimal prompting necessary • Predominantly effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform, in response to the set questions • Expresses opinions effectively and gives justification which is mostly developed • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible and predominantly accurate
13–16	• Responds to the set questions with consistently fluent and developed responses • Consistently effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform, in response to the set questions • Expresses opinions with ease and gives fully-developed justification • Pronunciation and intonation are consistently accurate and intelligible

Additional guidance

Adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform: adapts language to achieve different purposes in the language; students may adapt language more effectively for one purpose than another, for example they may use language effectively to inform but less effectively to narrate.

Picture-based task: linguistic knowledge and accuracy - Higher tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–2	• Some accurate grammatical structures, including some successful references to past, present and future events in response to the set questions, some ambiguity • Responses are partially coherent, errors occur that sometimes hinder clarity of communication and occasionally prevent meaning being conveyed
3–4	• Generally accurate grammatical structures, generally successful references to past, present and future events in response to the set questions, occasional ambiguity • Responses are generally coherent although errors occur that occasionally hinder clarity of communication
5–6	• Predominantly accurate grammatical structures, mostly successful references to past, present and future events in response to the set questions • Responses are predominantly coherent, errors occur but they rarely hinder clarity of communication
7–8	• Consistently accurate grammatical structures, successful references to past, present and future events in response to the set questions • Responses are coherent, any errors do not hinder the clarity of the communication

Additional guidance

Errors: students are not expected to produce perfect, error-free speech in order to access the top band as errors are also made by native speakers. The mark grid describes the frequency of errors and the impact that errors have on clarity.

Errors that **do not hinder clarity**:

- errors that do not affect meaning, for example gender, adjectival agreements
- infrequent errors that do not distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **hinder clarity**:

- errors that make speech difficult to understand immediately (even if the meaning is eventually understood)/errors that force listeners to strain to understand what is meant, for example inappropriate tense formation, mismatch of subject and the possessive adjective
- frequent errors hinder clarity as they distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **prevent meaning being conveyed**:

- errors that mean the listener cannot understand the message
- errors that convey the wrong message
- errors that make it unclear who is doing the action, i.e. using the incorrect person of the verb
- mother-tongue interference.

NB: these are examples only and do not constitute a finite list.

Conversation - Higher tier (36 marks)

There are three mark grids to be applied to this task, they are:

- communication and content
- interaction and spontaneity
- linguistic knowledge and accuracy.

Conversation: communication and content - Higher tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–3	• Communicates information relevant to the topics and questions, with occasionally extended sequences of speech • Uses language to produce straightforward ideas, thoughts and opinions with occasional justification • Uses a limited variety of mainly straightforward vocabulary, communication for some purposes is constrained because of restricted range of vocabulary • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, occasionally inaccuracies affect clarity of communication
4–6	• Communicates information relevant to the topics and questions, with some extended sequences of speech • Occasionally uses language creatively to express some individual thoughts, ideas and opinions, some of which are justified • Occasional variety in use of vocabulary, including some examples of uncommon language with some variation of expression, fulfils most purposes • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, inaccuracies are minimal and have no impact on clarity of communication
7–9	• Communicates detailed information relevant to the topics and questions, usually with extended sequences of speech • Frequently uses language creatively to express and justify a variety of individual thoughts, ideas and opinions • Uses a variety of vocabulary, including frequent use of uncommon language, to regularly vary expression for different purposes • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible and predominantly accurate
10–12	• Communicates detailed information relevant to the topics and questions, consistently extended sequences of speech • Consistently uses language creatively to express and justify a wide variety of individual thoughts, ideas and opinions • Consistently uses a wide variety of vocabulary, including uncommon language, to consistently vary expression for different purposes • Pronunciation and intonation are consistently accurate and intelligible

Additional guidance

Uses language creatively: examples of creative language use are:

- using language to create an effect
- manipulating language, including familiar, high frequency and simple language, to respond to unfamiliar/unexpected contexts and purposes
- using language to express thoughts, ideas, feelings and emotions
- using language to inform and narrate ideas, thoughts and points of view to maintain interest
- applying a variety of vocabulary and structures to maintain interest
- using language effectively to achieve more complex purposes, for example to interest, to convince.

Individual thoughts, ideas and opinions: this is linked to creative use of language whereby students use language to express original thoughts, ideas and points of view that go beyond the minimum/standard/predictable response.

Straightforward ideas, thoughts and opinions are those that give the minimum/standard/predictable response.

Conversation: interaction and spontaneity - Higher tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–3	- Occasionally able to respond spontaneously with some examples of natural interaction although often stilted - Occasionally able to initiate and develop responses independently but regular prompting needed - Occasionally able to sustain communication, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow; frequent hesitation
4–6	- Responds spontaneously to some questions, interacting naturally for parts of the conversation - Sometimes able to initiate and develop the conversation independently, some prompting needed - Sometimes able to sustain communication, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow; some hesitation
7–9	- Responds to most questions spontaneously, resulting in mostly natural interaction - Mostly able to initiate and develop the conversation independently - Able to sustain communication throughout most of the conversation, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow, occasional hesitation
10–12	- Responds spontaneously and with ease to questions, resulting in natural interaction - Consistently able to initiate and develop the conversation independently - Able to sustain communication throughout, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow

Additional guidance

Respond(s) spontaneously: gives a relevant, impromptu response based on what they have heard.

Rephrasing/repair strategies are strategies that aid communication and allow the conversation to be sustained, for example rephrasing, circumlocution, adjusting the message, asking for clarification/repetition, repair strategies such as self-correction; these strategies enable students to deliver the message when exact vocabulary or expressions are not known.

Conversation: linguistic knowledge and accuracy - Higher tier

Mark	Descriptor
0	No rewardable material
1–3	• Manipulates a limited variety of mainly straightforward grammatical structures, minimal use of complex structures • Some accurate grammatical structures, some successful references to past, present and future events, some ambiguity • Sequences of coherent speech although errors occur that often hinder clarity of communication and occasionally prevent meaning being conveyed
4–6	• Manipulates grammatical structures with occasional variation, complex structures used but repetitive • Generally accurate grammatical structures, generally successful references to past, present and future events • Generally coherent speech although errors occur that sometimes hinder clarity of communication
7–9	• Manipulates a variety of grammatical structures, some variety of complex structures • Predominantly accurate grammatical structures, mostly successful references to past, present and future events • Predominantly coherent speech; errors occur but they rarely hinder clarity of communication
10–12	• Manipulates a wide variety of grammatical structures, frequent use of complex structures • Consistently accurate grammatical structures, consistently successful references to past, present and future events • Fully coherent speech; any errors do not hinder the clarity of the communication

Additional guidance

Complex grammatical structures are considered to be:

- all grammar and structures that are included in the grammar list which are specific to Higher tier GCSE
- varied and complex word order
- using extended sentences that include a range of structures, for example conjunctions, pronouns, reported speech and/or a range of lexis, for example to express abstract ideas/convey justified arguments
- conceptually more challenging language

Straightforward grammatical structures are considered to be:

- repetitive, simple word order
- short, simple sentences that use a repetitive range of common, high-frequency structures
- simple ideas, opinions and thoughts that are expressed but are not justified.

Errors: students are not expected to produce perfect, error-free speech in order to access the top band as errors are also made by native speakers. The mark grid describes the frequency of errors and the impact that errors have on clarity.

Errors that **do not hinder clarity**:

- errors that do not affect meaning, for example gender, adjectival agreements
- infrequent errors that do not distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **hinder clarity**:

- errors that make speech difficult to understand immediately (even if the meaning is eventually understood)/errors that force listeners to strain to understand what is meant, for example inappropriate tense formation, mismatch of subject and the possessive adjective
- frequent errors hinder clarity as they will distract the listener from the content of what is being said.

Errors that **prevent meaning being conveyed**:

- errors that mean the listener cannot understand the message
- errors that convey the wrong message
- errors that make it unclear who is doing the action, i.e. using the incorrect person or the verb
- mother-tongue interference.

NB: these are examples only and do not constitute a finite list.

Paper 3: Reading and understanding in Spanish

Content

Students are assessed on their understanding of written Spanish across a range of different types of texts.

Students need to:

- identify the overall message, key points, details and opinions in texts
- deduce meaning from a variety of written texts
- recognise the relationship between past, present and future events
- understand texts, organise and present relevant details, and, where appropriate, draw inferences in context and recognise implicit meaning
- recognise and respond to key information, important themes and ideas in more extended written text, including authentic sources, adapted and abridged as appropriate, by being able to answer questions, extract information.

This paper draws on vocabulary and structures across all the themes (pages 7–8).

Texts for individual questions within the assessment use high-frequency language and vary in length, including both short and longer written passages. Texts include authentic sources that introduce more complex language and unfamiliar materials.

The range of text types include:

- advertisements, emails, letters, articles and literary texts
- a short passage to be translated from Spanish into English.

Literary texts consist of short extracts from texts that may have been adapted and abridged from authentic sources to be appropriate to this level – from letters, short stories, novels or plays to contemporary and historical sources. Students are also expected to translate a short passage of written Spanish into English to demonstrate an ability to transfer meaning accurately into English.

Scenarios in the texts are set either at home or, more frequently, in a Spanish-speaking country, allowing students to develop appropriate cultural awareness and understanding.

To prepare students adequately for this assessment, teachers should present and exploit a range of vocabulary relevant to each theme listed, building on the Key Stage 3 Programme of Study, where appropriate.

Students should be presented with Spanish language in a range of styles or registers and in a variety of different contexts, as appropriate to their age and level of understanding. Students should also be presented with different fonts and formats, for example short, printed messages, articles and email messages.

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment time is:
 - o Foundation tier - 45 minutes in length
 - o Higher tier - 1 hour in length.
- The assessment is out of 50 marks.
- The assessment consists of 10 questions.
- Students must answer all questions from each of the three sections.
- Students are required to respond to questions based on passages of text from a range of sources. Each question is set in a context drawn from the themes.
- Section A has six questions set in English. Question types comprise both multiple-response and short-answer open response questions. The instructions to students are in English.
- Section B contains three questions set in Spanish. The instructions to students are in Spanish.
 - o For the Foundation tier there are three multiple-response questions.
 - o For the Higher tier, there are two multiple-response questions and one short-answer open response question.
- Section C contains one translation passage from Spanish into English. The instructions to students are in English.
- Four of the questions are common to both tiers.
- The use of dictionaries is not permitted.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Spanish* Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.